

1 Exercise 1

Let S be the set {rock, paper, scissors}. Define a binary operation $*$: $S \times S \rightarrow S$ via

$$x * y = \begin{cases} \text{the winner of a rock-paper-scissors game between } x \text{ and } y, & \text{if } x \neq y \\ x, & \text{if } x = y. \end{cases}$$

- (a) Prove that $*$ is a commutative operation on S .
- (b) Prove that $*$ is not an associative operation on S .

1.1 Solution (a)

Proof. Commutativity means that $x * y = y * x$.

There are two cases: when $x = y$ and $x \neq y$. Begin with the former. If $x = y$, $x * y = x$ and $y * x = y$. By the transitive property, since $x * y = x$ and $x = y$, $x * y = y$. Also by the transitive property, since $x * y = y$ and $y * x = y$, $x * y = y * x$. Ergo, if $x = y$, $x * y$ is commutative.

Now the case where $x \neq y$. Without loss of generality, suppose that x has the advantage over y (i.e. x is rock when y is scissors, x is scissors when y is paper, etc.). In this case, x will always beat y in a game of ro-sham-bo, so $x * y = x$. Meanwhile, $y * x$ also results in a game of ro-sham-bo, which x has the advantage in and will win, so $y * x = x$. Since $x * y = x$ and $y * x = x$, by the transitive property, $x * y = y * x$.

Ergo, $*$ is a commutative operation on S . OEΔ

1.2 Solution (b)

Proof by Counterexample. For the associative property to hold, it must be the case that for any r, p , and s in S , $(r * p) * s = r * (p * s)$. Suppose that $r = \text{rock}$, $p = \text{paper}$, and $s = \text{scissors}$. We can perform the internal operations on them. Start with $(r * p) * s$.

$$(r * p) * s = p * s = s = \text{scissors} \tag{1}$$

Then, $r * (p * s)$.

$$r * (p * s) = r * s = r = \text{rock} \tag{2}$$

For associativity to hold, it would require that $s = r$, meaning scissors = rock, which is expressly not true. That acts as a counterexample, so associativity does not hold. OEΔ

2 Exercise 2

Let F be an ordered field with additive identity 0 and multiplicative identity 1.

- (a) Using **only** the field and ordered field axioms, prove that if $a, b \in F$ with $a > 0$ and $0 < b < 1$, then $0 < ab < a$.
- (b) Using **only** the field axioms, prove that if $a, b, c, d \in F$, then $((a+b)+c)+d = d+(c+(b+a)) = ((d+c)+b)+a$.

2.1 Solution (a)

Proof. The multiplicative ordered field axiom states that if for some a and b in F , $a \leq b$ and $c \geq 0$, then $ac \leq bc$.

Since $0 < b$ and $0 < a$, $0 \leq b$ and $0 \leq a$. In the same vein, since $b < 1$, $b \leq 1$.

By the multiplicative axiom, $0 \cdot a \leq ab$ and $ab \leq a$.

We proved that $0 \cdot x = 0$ in class, so $0 \cdot a = 0$ and $0 \geq ab$.

We proved in class that if $x \neq 0$ and $y \neq 0$, then $xy \neq 0$. Since $0 < a$, $a \neq 0$. Since $0 < b$, $b \neq 0$. Therefore, $ab \neq 0$. Since $0 \leq ab$ and $0 \neq ab$, $0 < ab$.

We proved in class that if $x \neq 0$ and $xy = xz$, then $y = z$. Its contrapositive is that if $y \neq z$, then $x = 0$ or $xy \neq xz$. Since $b < 1$, $b \neq 1$. This means that either $a = 0$ or $ab \neq a$. Since $a \neq 0$, $ab \neq a$.

$ab \leq a$ and $ab \neq a$, so $ab < a$.

Since $0 < ab$ and $ab < a$, $0 < ab < a$.

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2.2 Solution (b)

Proof. Our first half of the proof will consist of a long series of equalities, all of which are justified by the commutative property. The commutative property of addition says that $a + b = b + a$.

$$((a + b) + c) + d = ((b + a) + c) + d \quad (3)$$

$$= (c + (b + a)) + d \quad (4)$$

$$= d + (c + (b + a)) \quad (5)$$

Therefore, $((a + b) + c) + d = d + (c + (b + a))$.

The second half of the proof will consist of a long series of equalities, all of which are justified by the associative property. The associative property of addition says that $(a + b) + c = a + (b + c)$, or equivalently that $a + b + c$ is unambiguous.

$$d + (c + (b + a)) = (d + c) + (b + a) \quad (6)$$

$$= ((d + c) + b) + a \quad (7)$$

Therefore, $d + (c + (b + a)) = ((d + c) + b) + a$.

Ergo, $((a + b) + c) + d = d + (c + (b + a)) = ((d + c) + b) + a$.

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3 Exercise 3

Let F be a field with order $<$. Recall from class that $(F, <)$ is called an *ordered field* if the following axioms are satisfied:

- (i) For all $a, b, c \in F$ with $a \leq b$, we have $a + c \leq b + c$.
- (ii) For all $a, b, c \in F$ with $a \leq b$ and $0 \leq c$, we have $ac \leq bc$.
- (a) Prove that axiom (ii) is *equivalent* to the axiom
 - (ii)' For all $a, b \in F$ with $a > 0$ and $b > 0$, we have $ab > 0$
 That is, prove that (ii) is true if and only if (ii)' is true. This means that whether we use (ii) or (ii)' in our definition of an ordered field is irrelevant.
- (b) Define a relation $\prec$ on $\mathbb{Q}$ by declaring $a \prec b$ if and only if $b < a$ in the usual order on $\mathbb{Q}$. Prove that $\prec$ is an order on $\mathbb{Q}$ and that axiom (i) is true for $\prec$, but that axiom (ii) fails. Thus $(\mathbb{Q}, \prec)$ is an ordered set but not an ordered field.

Note: The LaTeX commands for $\prec, \preceq, \succ, \succeq$ are `\prec`, `\preceq`, `\succ`, and `\succeq`, respectively.

3.1 Solution (a)

Proof. First the forward direction, meaning (ii) implies (ii)'.

Take (ii), and suppose we set $a = 0$, rename b to a , and rename c to b . This may be confusing, but what we end up with is the following:

- (ii) For all $a, b \in F$ with $0 \leq a$ and $0 \leq b$, we have $0b \leq ab$.

We proved in class that $0x = 0$. Therefore, $0b = 0$ and we can replace $0b$ with just 0 .

- (ii) For all $a, b \in F$ with $0 \leq a$ and $0 \leq b$, we have $0 \leq ab$.

Since this applies for all a and b in F , including those that are not equal to 0 , we can set the rule of only considering cases where $a \neq 0$ and $b \neq 0$. Furthermore, we proved in class that if $x \neq 0$ and $y \neq 0$, then $xy \neq 0$. Since $a \neq 0$ and $b \neq 0$, $ab \neq 0$. Thereby, we can replace the $\leq$ signs with just $<$.

- (ii) For all $a, b \in F$ with $a > 0$ and $b > 0$, we have $ab > 0$.

This gets us to (ii)'.

Now for the backwards direction.

Since $a > 0$ and $b > 0$, without loss of generality, $0 < a \leq b$. Focus on the latter two terms, $a \leq b$. Part (i) tells us we can add $-a$, the additive inverse of a , to all sides and end up with $a - a \leq b - a$. By the additive inverse axiom, we know that $a - a = 0$. Therefore, $0 \leq b - a$. Let there also be some $0 \leq c$. From here, we bifurcate our proof between (1) $0 < b - a$ and $0 < c$, (2) $0 < b - a$ and $0 = c$, (3) $0 = b - a$ and $0 < c$, and (4) $0 = b - a$ and $0 = c$ cases.

(1) First, $0 < b - a$ and $0 < c$. By the axiom (ii)', since $0 < b - a$ and $0 < c$, $0 < c(b - a)$. By the distributive property, $c(b - a) = bc - ac$, so $0 < bc - ac$. The additive inverse axiom tells us that there exists some $-(-ac)$ such that $ac + (-(-ac)) = 0$. Part (i) tells us we can add $-(-ac)$ to all sides, so $-(-ac) < bc - ac - (-ac)$. In class, we proved that $-(-x) = x$, so $-(-ac) = ac$,

which we can replace in the equation to get $ac < bc - ac + ac$. The commutative property lets us say that $ac < bc + ac - ac$. By the additive inverse axiom, $ac - ac = 0$. Therefore, $ac < bc + 0$. By the additive identity, $bc + 0 = bc$, so $ac < bc$, and by extension $ac \leq bc$.

(2) Second, $0 < b - a$ and $0 = c$. If we multiply $(b - a)$ by c , it is the equivalent to multiplying $(b - a)$ by 0. This means that $c(b - a) = 0(b - a)$. In class, we proved that for all x , $0x = 0$. This means that $c(b - a) = 0(b - a) = 0$. The distributive property says that $c(b - a) = bc - ac$. Putting this together, we find $bc - ac = 0$. We can add $-(-ac)$, rewritten as ac , to both sides to find $bc - ac + ac = ac$. By the commutative property, $bc + ac - ac = ac$. By the additive identity axiom, $bc = ac$, and by extension $ac \leq bc$.

(3) Third, $0 = b - a$ and $0 < c$. If we multiply $(b - a)$ by c , it is the equivalent to multiplying c by 0. This means that $c(b - a) = c \cdot 0$. By the commutative property for multiplication, $c(b - a) = (b - a)c$ and $c \cdot 0 = 0c$, so $(b - a)c = 0c$. In class, we proved that for all x , $0x = 0$. This means that $(b - a)c = 0c = 0$. The distributive property says that $(b - a)c = bc - ac$. Putting this together, we find $bc - ac = 0$. We can add $-(-ac)$, rewritten as ac , to both sides to find $bc - ac + ac = ac$. By the commutative property, $bc + ac - ac = ac$. By the additive identity axiom, $bc = ac$, and by extension $ac \leq bc$.

(4) Last, $0 = b - a$ and $0 = c$. We can add $-(-a)$, which we proved in class is equal to a , to $0 = b - a$ to get $a = b - a + a$. The commutative property tells us that $a = b + a - a$. The additive inverse axiom says that $a = b + 0$. The additive identity axiom says that $b = b + 0$, so $a = b$. Multiply both sides by c to get $ac = bc$, and by extension $ac \leq bc$.

Ergo, this proves that if $a \leq b$ and $c \geq 0$, $ac \leq bc$.

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3.2 Solution (b)

Proof. The textbook says that $\mathbb{Q}$ is an ordered set if $r > s$ is defined to mean that $r - s$ is a positive rational number. I will start by using this to prove that $\mathbb{Q}$ is an ordered field.

Every number q in $\mathbb{Q}$ can be written in terms of one integer a and one natural number b in the form $q = \frac{a}{b}$. Let there be three rational numbers $\frac{a}{b}$, $\frac{c}{d}$, and $\frac{e}{f}$ such that $\frac{a}{b} < \frac{c}{d}$. Cross-multiply these fractions, bearing in mind that b and d are both positive non-zero integers, to get $ad < bc$. Multiply both sides by f^2 to get $adf^2 < bcf^2$. Add the integer $bdef$ to both sides to get $adf^2 + bdef < bcf^2 + bdef$. Apply the distributive property by df on the left side and bf on the right side to get $df(af + be) < bf(cf + de)$. Divide both sides by bf and df to get $\frac{af+be}{bf} < \frac{cf+de}{df}$. Separate both fractions into two and cancel out terms to get $\frac{a}{b} + \frac{e}{f} < \frac{c}{d} + \frac{e}{f}$. This means that the rational numbers satisfy the first ordered field axiom.

Let there be three rational numbers $\frac{a}{b}$, $\frac{c}{d}$, and $\frac{e}{f}$ such that $\frac{a}{b} \leq \frac{c}{d}$ and $\frac{e}{f} \geq 0$. Since $\frac{e}{f} \geq 0$, we can multiply both sides by f to get $\frac{ef}{f} \geq 0f$. Since we established in class that $0f = 0$, $\frac{ef}{f} \geq 0$. By the multiplicative inverse, $\frac{f}{f} = 1$, so $\frac{ef}{f} = e \cdot 1 \geq 0$. By the multiplicative identity, $e \cdot 1 = e \geq 0$. Therefore, $e \geq 0$ and $f > 0$, and both are integers. Multiply both sides of $e \geq 0$ by f to get $ef \geq 0f = 0$ by what was established in class. Therefore, $ef \geq 0$. Take our initial inequality of equations $\frac{a}{b} \leq \frac{c}{d}$ and cross-multiply to get $ad \leq bc$. Multiply both sides by ef to get $adef \leq bcef$. Divide both sides by bf and df to get $\frac{ae}{bf} \leq \frac{ce}{df}$. These fractions can be separated to find $\frac{a}{b} \cdot \frac{e}{f} \leq \frac{c}{d} \cdot \frac{e}{f}$. This means that the rational numbers satisfy the first ordered field axiom, and by extension that the rational number are an ordered field.

We start by proving that $<$ is an order on $\mathbb{Q}$. We know that either $a < b$, $a = b$, or $a > b$. Based on that and that $a > b$ means $a < b$, we find that either $a > b$, $a = b$, or $a < b$.¹ Next, suppose that $a > b$ and $b > c$. This means that $a < b$ and $b < c$. We know from the first ordered

¹Could expand on this entire paragraph.

field axiom that if $a < b$ and $b < c$, then $a < c$, so in this case $a < c$. Because of that, we can say that $a > c$. In total, if $a > b$ and $b > c$, then $a > c$. This all means that $<$ is an order on $\mathbb{Q}$.

Next, we prove that for all a, b , and c in $\mathbb{Q}$ with $a \preceq b$, we have $a + c \preceq b + c$. That is to say, for all a, b , and c in $\mathbb{Q}$ with $a \geq b$, we have $a + c \geq b + c$. Take the first field axiom, applied to the rational numbers.

- (i) For all $a, b, c \in \mathbb{Q}$ with $a \leq b$, we have $a + c \leq b + c$.

Swap a and b .

- (i) For all $a, b, c \in \mathbb{Q}$ with $b \leq a$, we have $b + c \leq a + c$.

Swap every $\leq$ with $\succeq$, the two being equivalent since $a < b$ if and only if $a > b$ and $a = b$ being possible either way.

- (i) For all $a, b, c \in \mathbb{Q}$ with $b \succeq a$, we have $b + c \succeq a + c$.

Ergo, axiom (i) is true for $<$.

Axiom (ii) can be proven impossible by counterexample. First, we restate the axiom for $<$.

- (ii) For all $a, b, c \in F$ with $a \leq b$ and $0 \leq c$, we have $ac \leq bc$.

Replace $<$ with $<$ and $\leq$ with $\preceq$.

- (ii) For all $a, b, c \in F$ with $a \preceq b$ and $0 \preceq c$, we have $ac \preceq bc$.

Based on the definition of $<$, we can replace $a \preceq b$ with $a \geq b$, $0 \preceq c$ with $0 \geq c$, and $ac \preceq bc$ with $ac \geq bc$.

- (ii) For all $a, b, c \in F$ with $a \geq b$ and $0 \geq c$, we have $ac \geq bc$.

Suppose that $a = 2$, $b = 1$, and $c = -1$. Since $2 \geq 1$, $a \geq b$. Since $0 \geq -1$, $0 \geq c$. ac is equal to -2 and bc is equal to -1 . Since $-2 < -1$, $ac < bc$, which means that $ac \not\geq bc$, which contradicts the second field axiom. As such, axiom (ii) fails.

Ergo, $(\mathbb{Q}, <)$ is an ordered set but not an ordered field.

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4 Exercise 4

Let $S \subset \mathbb{R}$ be nonempty and bounded from above. Let $a = \sup S$.

- (a) Show that, for any real $\epsilon > 0$, there is $x \in S$ with $x > a - \epsilon$.
- (b) Suppose $a \notin S$. Show that, for any real $\epsilon > 0$, there are infinitely many elements of S in the open interval $(a - \epsilon, a)$.

4.1 Solution (a)

Proof by Contradiction. Suppose for contradiction that, for any real $\epsilon > 0$, there does not exist $x \in S$ with $x > a - \epsilon$. This means that, for all $x \in S$, $x \leq a - \epsilon$. This means that $a - \epsilon$ is an upper bound of S .

We know that $\epsilon > 0$. Add a to both sides of S , which through the first ordered field axiom and the fact that $\mathbb{R}$ is an ordered field means that $a + \epsilon > a$. By the additive inverse property of fields, there exists some $-\epsilon$ such that $\epsilon + (-\epsilon) = 0$. Add $-\epsilon$ to both sides of $a + \epsilon > a$ to get $a + \epsilon - \epsilon > a - \epsilon$. By the additive inverse property of fields, $a + \epsilon - \epsilon = a > a - \epsilon$.

Therefore, there exists an upper bound of S that is less than a in the form of $a - \epsilon$. Therefore, a is not the least upper bound of S . This contradicts that a is the least upper bound of S , so our initial assumption must be false. Ergo, for any real $\epsilon > 0$, there is $x \in S$ with $x > a - \epsilon$. OE Δ

4.2 Solution (b)

Proof. An infinite number of elements in the interval means that the elements can be mapped onto the natural numbers or a set with a larger cardinality.

We can define a set Z recursively. Suppose that the first element of Z , denoted ζ_0 , is equal to $a - \epsilon$. As established in part (a), there exists some x in S with $x > a - \epsilon$. We can create a new set X and call the x in S with $x > a - \epsilon$, x_1 . Since a is the least upper bound of S , it is an upper bound of S , meaning that because x_0 is in S , $x_1 < a$.

Now, suppose that we have element n (in the natural numbers) of x , denoted x_n , which is an element of S . Since x_n is an element of S and a is an upper bound of S , $x_n < a$. Add the additive inverse of x_n , $-x_n$, to both sides, which due to the first ordered field axiom becomes $x_n - x_n < a - x_n$. By the additive inverse definition, $x_n - x_n = 0$, so $0 < a - x_n$. Since $\mathbb{R}$ is a field and fields are closed under addition, $a - x_n$ is a real number. We can denote $a - x_n$ as ζ_n . Since ζ_n is real and greater than 0, it is possible that some new $\epsilon = \zeta_n$. Now take $a - \zeta_n$. As established in part (a), there exists some x in S with $x > a - \zeta_n$. We can call the x in S with $x > a - \zeta_n$ that we just discovered existed x_{n+1} .

This pairs up our subset of the set of elements of S in the open interval $(a - \epsilon, a)$ with the natural numbers. This means that the cardinality of the natural numbers is less than or equal to the cardinality of the set of elements of S in the open interval $(a - \epsilon, a)$. The cardinality of the natural numbers is countably infinite. Ergo, the cardinality of the set of elements of S in the open interval $(a - \epsilon, a)$ is infinite. OE Δ

5 Exercise 5

For an integer $m \geq 2$, we define $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ to be the set $\{0, 1, \dots, m-1\}$, together with the operations of addition and multiplication modulo m . That is, to add two elements of m , we add them as we normally would and then take the remainder upon division by m . Multiplication is defined similarly. Thus, in $\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z}$ for example, we have $2 + 4 = 3$ and $4 \cdot 4 = 1$.

You may assume that all of the axioms for addition, multiplication, and distributivity from fields also hold in $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ (with 0 and 1 as the identities), *except* for the axiom

(*) every nonzero element has a multiplicative inverse
which is the subject of this problem.

- (a) Show that if m is a composite number, then axiom (*) fails.
- (b) Show that if m is a prime number, then axiom (*) holds. That is, $\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$ is a field with only finitely many elements!

Hint for part (b): You may use *Bézout's identity* from number theory: if $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ are coprime then there are $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ so that $ax + by = 1$. Then use that for a prime p , the integers $1, 2, \dots, p-1$ are all coprime to p . You may also use the *Euclidean division theorem*: namely if b is a positive integer, then any $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ may be written uniquely as $a = bq + r$, where $0 \leq r < b$.

5.1 Solution (a)

Proof. Having a multiplicative inverse in a set means that for any number a in that set there exists some number a^{-1} also in that set for which $a \cdot a^{-1} = 1$. OEΔ

6 Exercise 6

Let F be a finite field with identities 0 and 1.

- (a) Show that there is an integer $n \geq 2$ so that $\underbrace{1 + 1 + \cdots + 1}_{n \text{ times}} = 0$. (*Hint:* by the pigeonhole principle, at least two different sums of the form $1 + 1 + \cdots + 1$ must be equal)
- (b) By using the fact that $\underbrace{1 + 1 + \cdots + 1}_{ab \text{ times}} = (\underbrace{1 + 1 + \cdots + 1}_{a \text{ times}})(\underbrace{1 + 1 + \cdots + 1}_{b \text{ times}})$ for $a, b \geq 2$, show that the *smallest* possible integer n from part (a) is prime.
- (c) Using part (a), show that there are no finite ordered fields.